

Clency Christine

Applying for: OpenAI Research Residency 2026

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Education

Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology

Nairobi, Kenya

B.Sc. Mathematics and Computer Science

08/2023 - 12/2027

- Relevant coursework: Advanced Mathematics (Linear Algebra, Probability & Statistics, Calculus), Data Structures & Algorithms, Software Engineering
- Self-studied machine learning fundamentals via Udacity Nano degree Programme, and reading research papers from scratch

Experience & Projects

Developer – GKash

10/25 – Present

- Co-built (all-women team) GKash, a mobile-first fintech app using AI to teach saving and investing to underserved communities in Kenya, with emphasis on women entrepreneurs and gig workers
- Designed interactive, personalized lessons, micro-savings trackers, investment simulations, and inclusive features (voice guidance, simple UI) to overcome literacy barriers
- Won **2nd Place** nationally in the 2025 Absa GirlCodeHack (Pan-African women-in-tech competition focused on FinTech/AI/Cybersecurity)
- Selected into competitive accelerator program providing mentorship, technical resources, and investor connections for scaling

Backend Engineer – Creative Credit AI

Fintech Platform for Creatives & Gig Workers | 09/25 – Present
Kenya

- Led development of an AI-powered credit scoring and financial analytics platform tailored for creatives and gig workers in emerging markets
- Built real-time fraud detection models and backend systems integrating income stream data (e.g., M-Pesa, PayPal, gig platforms) for dynamic credit assessment
- Designed financial monitoring tools with anomaly detection to reduce risk and enable equitable lending

Software Developer – HakiChain

06/25 - 11/25

- Engineered a web-crawling and data-scraping pipeline to extract and structure case law data from Kenya Law Reports (kenyalaw.org)
- Processed scraped data into contextual embeddings to provide rich, relevant context for a Gemini-based legal research and reasoning model
- Developed secure backend architecture (Python/FastAPI, Vercel) with role-based access for pilot users (lawyers) and integrated search/query capabilities powered by retrieved case law

Community & Impact Projects

Independent / Community Contributions

09/25 – Present

- Organized GDG on Campus workshops on AI/ML and cloud computing; co-organized AI Students Summit 2025 and Datathon 2026 @ JKUAT

Self-Directed AI Research & Implementation

Ongoing

- Deeply engaged with frontier AI research: regularly study papers from MIT CSAIL, ArXiv preprints by leading researchers (Ilya Sutskever, Yann LeCun, Karpathy), and publications from OpenAI, DeepMind, Anthropic
- Experimented with reinforcement learning, scaling laws, alignment techniques, and retrieval-augmented generation through personal projects

Awards and Honors

2nd Place, Absa GirlCodeHack 2025 – Pan-African2025 **3rd Place**, Code Her Hackathon – Pan-African2025 Women-in-Tech Hackathon (FinTech/AI track) Women-in-Tech Hackathon FinTech/AI innovation which ha secured spots in the 3 week residency programme.

Skills

Programming Languages:  Python, SQL, Kotlin, currently on C++

Mathematics: Linear Algebra, Probability & Statistics, Multivariate Calculus, Optimization (very comfortable implementing from first principles)

Tools & Frameworks: Git/GitHub, Docker, FastAPI, Django, Jupyter notebooks, Colab, Firebase, AWS basics, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Languages: English (fluent),